

of the four years. This simple approach to real estate investing helped propel him toward financial independence by the time he was in his late twenties.

Carson explained that there are two parts to finding good deals. He said most of us are good at the first one without needing much experience. It is qualitatively finding a good home in a good neighborhood. His rule of thumb is to find a house in a neighborhood where he would want to live. He said, “Buying or renting a home to live in is an emotional decision, so you make money in real estate by delivering a product that has emotional appeal because living in a home is emotional.” The other half of the equation is quantitative. You have to do your homework to learn the market where you want to invest, understand financing, then put it all together to know if a deal will be profitable while delivering value to others. Carson said being a successful real estate investor means you have to be a “walking dichotomy”—balancing emotions and math all the time.

Leverage

Real estate allows you to leverage your specific skills, interests, and talents, adding value to deals to increase returns. This can be done in several ways. You can focus on a particular neighborhood, or even